



Creating an Azure Container Instance (ACI)

Learn how to create an Azure Container Instance (ACI) using Ansible playbook.

We'll cover the following ^

- Project overview
- Tools to have
- Writing the playbook
- Running the playbook
- Verifying playbook results
- Try it yourself!

It's time to get to the hands-on goodness! In this chapter project, you will create an [Azure Container Instance](#) (ACI) with an Nginx Docker image in Ansible using Azure Cloud Shell.

The Azure Cloud Shell has lots of pre-loaded applications and configuration; one of those is Ansible. Be sure to check out the command-line chapter to learn more about Azure Cloud Shell.



Project overview#

 Ask a Question



To get hands-on with Ansible to create an ACI, you're going to create an Ansible playbook via the [Azure Cloud Shell editor](#) that will run on the Ansible server to create a single ACI using a few variables and a task. Once the playbook is written, you will then run the playbook in Azure Cloud Shell to create the ACI.

Tools to have#

To follow along with the project in this chapter, please be sure that you open a PowerShell console via [Azure Cloud Shell](#).

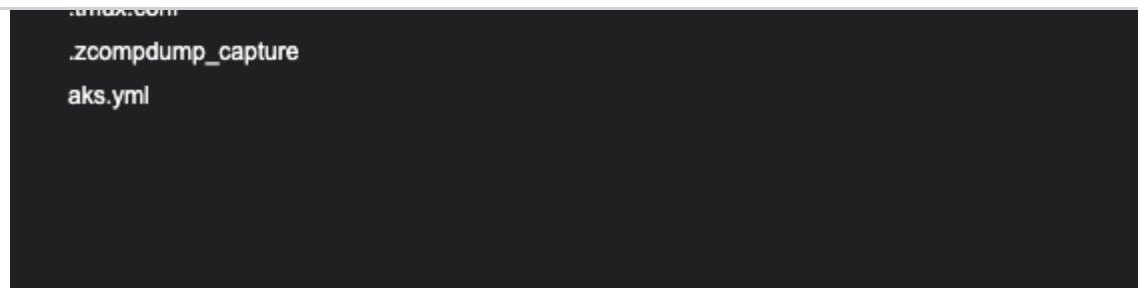
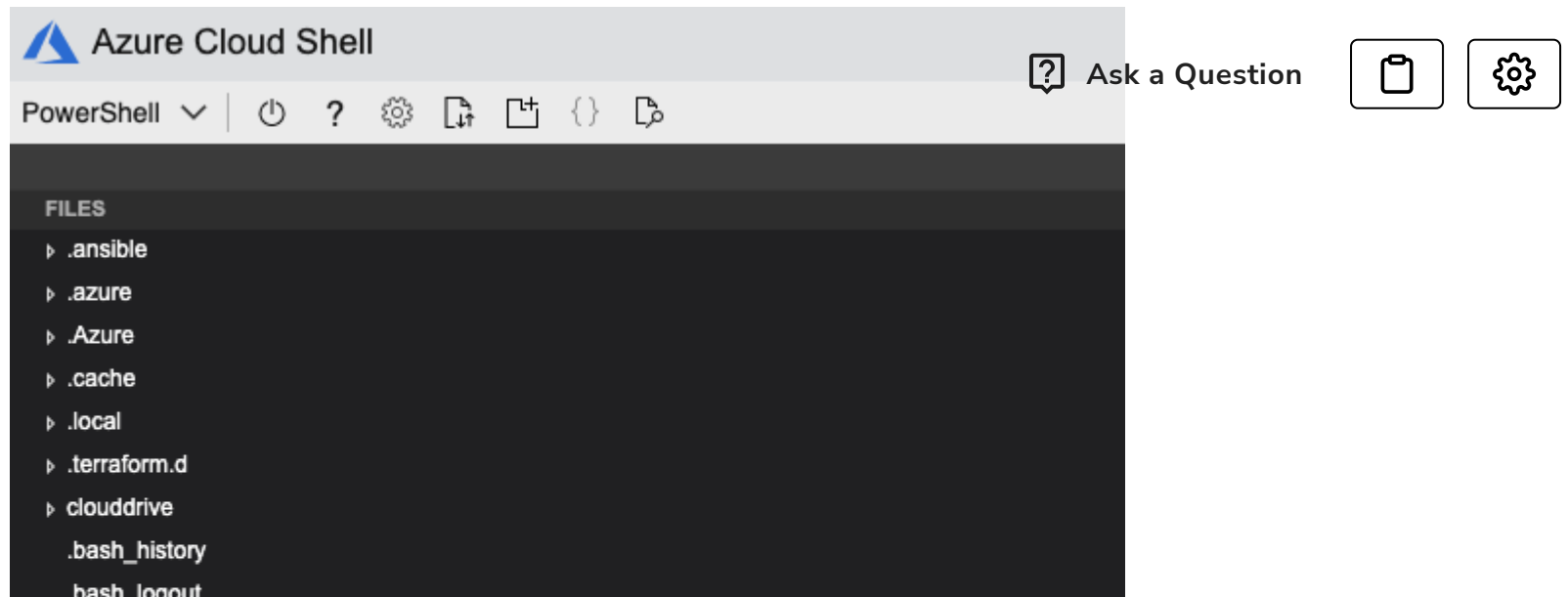
Writing the playbook#

To get started, let's first bring up a code editor. Although you can use any code editor you wish, let's keep this all in the Azure family by doing everything (even editing) in the Azure Cloud Shell. Assuming that you're in the Azure Cloud Shell staring at a PowerShell prompt, run `code ..` This command will bring up the Azure Cloud Shell editor and will open it up to the current directory.

The Azure Cloud Shell editor is a Visual Studio Code lookalike code editor available totally in the Azure Cloud Shell. No external programs are necessary.



Once open, you should see the editor show up above the PowerShell console as shown below.



Azure Cloud Shell

You'll see on the right-hand side of the editor a spot to write code.

Next, save the code by typing **Windows Key + S**. When you do, you will be prompted with a **Save new file?** box. Save the playbook as *acideploy.yml* and click on **Save**. This will create a playbook called *acideploy.yml* in  the root profile within your Azure Cloud Shell instance.

Running the playbook#

 Ask a Question



Now that the playbook has been created and saved, it's time to deploy the ACI. If you haven't moved from your profile, typing `ls` should show you the *acideploy.yml* file you just created.

To run the playbook and all tasks inside, run ACI, run `ansible-playbook acideploy.yml`, and wait a few minutes for Azure to create the ACI.

Note: For your convenience, we have already written a playbook for you in the below widget. All you have to do is provide the required environment variable values and then press the **RUN** button to see how the Ansible playbook works!

This code requires the following environment variables to execute: ^

AZURE_SUBSCRI...	Not Specified...
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AZURE_CLIENT_ID	Not Specified...
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AZURE_SECRET	Not Specified...
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AZURE_TENANT	Not Specified...
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Edit



```
- hosts: localhost
  connection: local
  vars:
    resourceGroup: NoBSDevOps
    name: nginxwebapp
    containerName: nginxwebapp
    image: 'nginx:latest'
  tasks:
    - name: Create an Azure Container Instance
      azure_rm_containerinstance:
        resource_group: '{{ resourceGroup }}'
        name: '{{ name }}'
        containers:
          - name: '{{ containerName }}'
            image: '{{ image }}'
            ports:
              - 80
              - 443
```

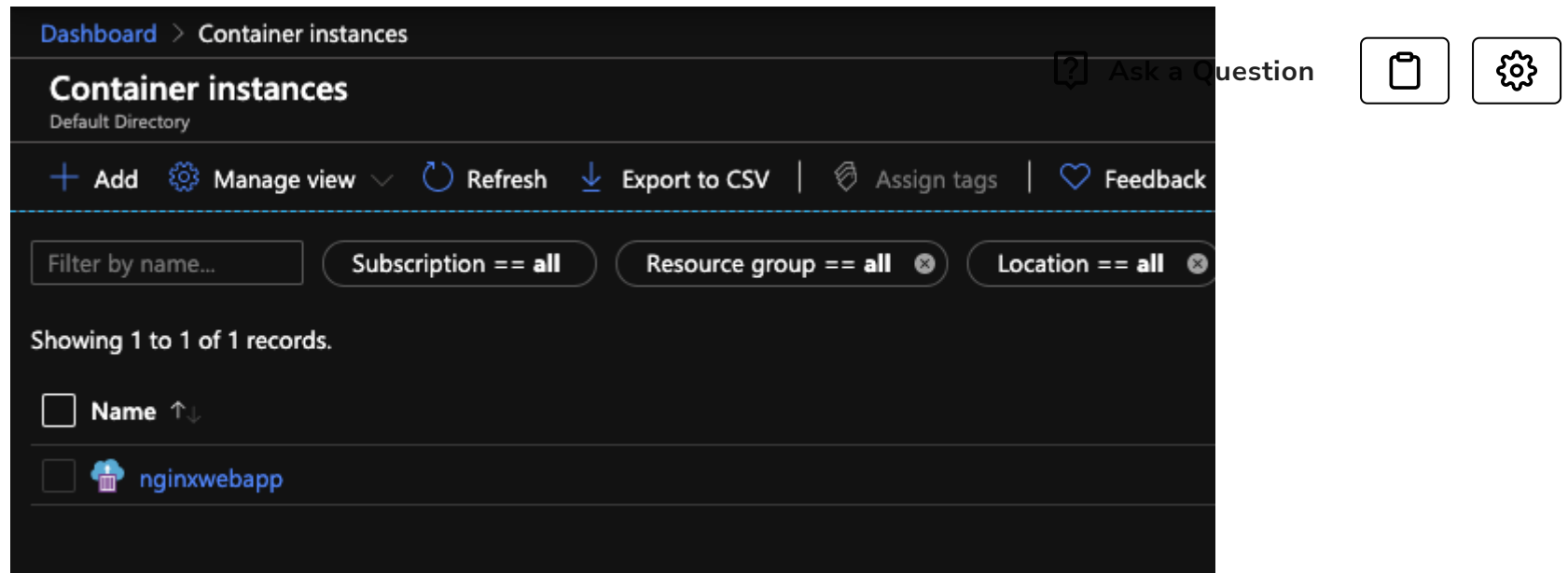
 Ask a Question



Verifying playbook results#

To confirm the playbook created the ACI, navigate to your Azure Portal and to the [ACI blade](#). Here you should see the container running. If so, you've successfully deployed an ACI using an Ansible playbook!





Container instances dashboard

Try it yourself!#

We have already configured the practice environment for you. So press the **Run** button, and try all the commands yourself.

This code requires the following environment variables to execute:		^
Username	Not Specified...	
Password	Not Specified...	
AZURE_SUBSCRI...	Not Specified...	
AZURE_CLIENT_ID	Not Specified...	☾

AZURE_SECRET	Not Specified...
AZURE_TENANT	Not Specified...
Git_Email	Not Specified...
Git_Name	Not Specified...

Edit

 Ask a Question



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Next 

Quiz on Ansible

 Mark as Completed

 Report an Issue

